



# AFRICA ECONOMIC FORUM 2026



Africa & Global Realignments:

Investments,  
Alliances &  
Strategic Opportunities

**10-11 NOVEMBER 2026**  
**KINSHASA, DRC**

## A Message from the Host

In a world shifting towards new geopolitical alliances and economic realignments, Africa must no longer be a passive observer. The Africa Economic Forum emerges as the continent's premier platform for high-level strategic dialogue and actionable investments.

We are not gathering merely to talk – we are here to connect ministers with markets, innovators with investors, and bold ideas with the capital they need to scale.

Kinshasa – a city at the heart of Africa's next chapter.

A meeting point for leaders, capital and ideas. A place to shape partnerships that matter.

Welcome to Kinshasa.

**Welcome to Africa's Davos.**

A handwritten signature in black ink that reads "Dr. Billy Issa". The signature is fluid and cursive, with the first letters of each word being capitalized and prominent.

Visionary Founder,  
Africa Economic Forum



## ABOUT THE AFRICA ECONOMIC FORUM

As an architect of economic and influence ecosystems, we support governments in designing and implementing strategies for economic, diplomatic, and territorial attractiveness—with a clear goal: to attract investment and position their territory as a hub for regional or continental growth.

# WHY ATTEND?

**High-Impact Networking:** AI-powered matchmaking for investors, startups, and policymakers.

**Deal Flows:** Pre-vetted projects, MoU signings, and sovereign fund pitches.

**Geopolitical Insights:** Learn how Africa can leverage US-China-Gulf dynamics.

**Exclusive Access:** Closed-door roundtables with ministers, CEOs, and Gulf royalty.



# KEY HIGHLIGHTS

- Diplomatic Breakfast: Ministers & CEOs in 1:1 deal sessions.
- Africa-Gulf Investment Pipeline: 50 high-impact projects unveiled.
- Currency Wars Panel: Gold-backed trade agreements signing.
- Tech Sovereignty Debate: MoU between African fintechs and UAE's ADGM.

# WHY SPONSOR?

1. Position Your Brand at the Center of Africa's Economic Future
2. Access High-Impact Decision-Makers
3. Shape the Global Conversation on Africa
4. Exclusive Deal Flow & Investment Insights
5. Showcase Your Commitments to ESG and Africa's Rise



# PROGRAM AGENDA – DAY 1

## 08:00 – 09:00

Welcome & Strategic Networking

Diplomatic Breakfast: Ministers, Gulf investors, and CEOs meet in curated 1:1 sessions.

Deal Matchmaking : AI-powered app to connect attendees based on investment interests (e.g., tech, energy, infrastructure).

## 09:00 – 10:30

Opening Session: Africa in the Geopolitics of Investment

Theme : How Africa Can Leverage US-China-Gulf Rivalries for Capital Flows

Moderator: (Economic Strategist, Africa Advisors).

### Speakers:

- Post-2024 US investor sentiment on Africa.
- Dubai as Africa's deal-making hub.
- Avoiding debt traps, attracting equity.
- Africa's tech unicorn potential.

Action : Launch of the "Africa-Gulf Investment Pipeline" (a pre-vetted portfolio of 50 high-impact projects).

## 10:30 – 12:00

**Panel 1** : Currency Wars & Financial Sovereignty

Theme: Dollar, Yuan, Crypto: How Africa Can Hedge Risks

### Speakers:

- Gold & tangible assets.
- Blockchain for African currencies.
- Development banks' role.

Deal Component:

- Signing Ceremony : African central banks × Gulf sovereign funds on gold-backed trade agreements.

## 12:00 – 14:00

**VIP Luncheon** : Closed-Door Deal Tables

- 10 curated roundtables (e.g., "Tech Exit Strategies", "Infrastructure PPPs") with CEOs and ministers.

- Pitch Zone: 5-minute startup pitches to Gulf sovereign funds (judged by Founders Fund and Saudi PIF).

## 14:00 – 15:30

**Panel 2** : Technology & Digital Sovereignty

Theme: Can Africa Bypass Western Tech Giants?

### Speakers:

- Local vs global tech dominance.
- Patient capital for startups.
- Why Silicon Valley bets on Africa.

Deal Component:

- MoU Signing: African fintechs

## 15:00 – 17:00

**Panel 3**: Energy & New Alliances

Theme: Oil, Green Gas, Nuclear: Who Will Fund Africa's Transition?

### Speakers:

- Fossil fuels vs renewables.
- Africa's natural gas race.
- Solar partnerships.

Deal Component:

- Live Auction : 3 African renewable energy projects bid on

## 17:00 – 18:30

The Grand African Deal

### Keynote:

- Industrialization & self-reliance.

### Announcements:

1. Africa-Gulf Infrastructure Fund (\$5B commitment from Saudi PIF + AfDB).
2. "Deal Room" Results: Live announcement of closed deals (e.g., "Nigeria signs \$1.2B rail PPP with DP World").

### 18:30 – 21:00

Celebration & Closed-Door Signings

- Deal Room Stays Open : Final negotiations with notaries on-site.
- 
- Performance : Burna Boy or Youssou N'Dour.

## PROGRAM AGENDA – DAY 2

### 08:00 – 09:00

Sector-Specific Breakfasts

- Agriculture: Hosted by
- Critical Minerals: Hosted by DRC Mining Ministry
- Health: Hosted by
- Infrastructure: Hosted by
- Tourism: Hosted by

### 09:00 – 10:30

**Plenary** : Intra-African Trade Revolution

Moderator :

#### Speakers:

- Pan-African payment systems
- Border modernization
- Digital trade corridors

Deal : Launch of Africa Trade Gateway digital platform

### 10:30 – 12:00

Parallel Sector Sessions

AGRICULTURE & AGRI-TECH

Theme : "Feeding 2 Billion by 2050"

#### Speakers:

- Climate-smart agriculture
- Gulf-Africa partnerships
- Vanilla & spice value chains

Deal : **\$200M** agri-processing zone announcement

### CRITICAL MINERALS

Theme : "From Extraction to Batteries"

#### Speakers:

- Lithium processing
- Local value addition
- Processing joint ventures

Deal: Rare earths refinery MoU

### HEALTH SOVEREIGNTY

Theme : "Vaccines to Pharma 4.0"

#### Speakers:

- Manufacturing partnerships
- mRNA tech transfer
- Vaccine logistics hubs

Deal : African mRNA consortium launch

### INFRASTRUCTURE

Theme : "Connecting the Next 500 Million"

#### Speakers:

- Desert-to-power initiative
- Port modernization
- Belt & Road 2.0

Deal : Trans-African rail feasibility signing

### TOURISM

Theme : "Luxury Safari to Space Tourism"

#### Speakers:

- Visa-free Africa
- Future tourism trends
- Island resort investments

Deal : \$1B eco-tourism fund launch

## **12:00 – 14:00**

### Deal Making Lunches

- Country-specific investment round-tables
- Startup pitch battles judged by:
  - Y Combinator
  - Saudi PIF Ventures
  - Norrsken Foundation

## **14:00 – 15:30**

### Commerce Wars Panel

Theme: "AfCFTA vs US/China Trade Blocs"

### **Speakers:**

- Multilateralism
- US Trade Representative - AGOA renewal
- - BRI priorities

Action : Live poll on trade alliance preferences

## **15:30 – 17:00**

### Future Sessions

### **AGRICULTURE**

Lab-grown meat demo by

### **MINERALS**

Asteroid mining talk by UAE Space Agency

### **HEALTH**

AI diagnostics showcase by

### **INFRASTRUCTURE**

Hyperloop prototype reveal

### **TOURISM**

Virtual reality safari experience

## **15:30 – 17:00**

### Closing Deal Rally

- Rapid-fire deal announcements (2 mins each)
- Africa Investment Scoreboard reveal
- "Unicorn Cup" award for top startup

## **18:30+**

### Cultural Closing

- Live art auction featuring African futurism
- Afrobeats beach party

# Speakers



**H.E Rosalia Arteaga**

Former President  
of Ecuador



**H.E Ameenah Gurib-Fakim**

H.E Ameenah Gurib-Fakim,  
Former President of Mauritius  
Honorary Chair of the AWF



**H.E Ana-Helena Chacón**

Former Vice President,  
Costa-Rica  
Honorary Chair of the  
AEF Diplomatic Club



**Hon. Abraham  
Dwuma Odoo**

Agriculture Expert, Former Ghana  
Member of Parliament & Deputy  
Minister



**Yassin Al Suroor**

AEF Senior Advisor  
strategic Partnerships &  
Economic Diplomacy  
(Global & Africa).



**NJ Ayuk**

Executive Chairman,  
African Energy Chamber



**Dr. Bu Abdullah**

Chairman, Bu Abdullah  
Investment Group



**JaQ Campbell**

CEO of JaQperience and  
Alexander Legacy  
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## **Contact:**

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